# Designing for delivery

*How does a good recommendation become a programme that actually works?*



# Today

By the end of today, you will have

**Built a theory of change, a responsibility matrix, a delivery approach and a risk register for your recommendation.**

- Build a theory of change and mark which links are evidenced and which are assumed.
- Assign decision rights and responsibilities with RAPID or RACI, using named roles.
- Choose whether to plan in full or build as you learn, and justify it.
- Identify and plan for the main risks, including frontline responses.

**Competencies: H1 · H2 · H3 · H4**

Session plan

| | |
|---|---|
| 10 min | **Opening problem** |
| 20 min | **Concept: theory of change** |
| 20 min | **Demonstration: Madhyapur delivery** |
| 35 min | **Activity: implementation breakdown** |
| 25 min | **Own case: implementation plan** |
| 10 min | **Debrief and exit task** |

# Opening problem

- **A state launched a well-designed scheme. Two years later, an audit finds that much of it was never delivered as designed. List five reasons that could explain this.**

How many of your reasons are about design, and how many about delivery?

# A theory of change for option B in Madhyapur




The dashed link is the key assumption: households will separate more once they see separation respected. It is evidenced in comparable cities, not yet in Madhyapur.

# The assumptions behind each link

| Link | Assumption | Evidence status |
|---|---|---|
| **Inputs to activities** | The cooperative can recruit and organise enough pickers | Partly evidenced in comparable cities |
| **Activities to outputs** | Crews will not take dry waste for their own sale | Assumed |
| **Outputs to intermediate outcomes** | Households respond to seeing separation respected | Evidenced elsewhere; untested here |
| **Intermediate to final outcomes** | Sorting centres find buyers for recyclables | Partly evidenced |

Assumptions are where programmes fail. Mark each one, and link the riskiest to an early indicator tomorrow.

# RAPID: who holds which role in the key decision

| Role | Meaning | Madhyapur: the cooperative contract |
|---|---|---|
| **Recommend** | Proposes the decision and gathers input | Head of the waste management department |
| **Agree** | Must sign off and can block | Finance and legal departments |
| **Perform** | Carries out the decision | The cooperative, ward staff and crews |
| **Input** | Consulted for expertise or impact | Councillors, resident associations, pickers' representatives |
| **Decide** | Makes the final call | Municipal Commissioner, with council approval of the budget |

RAPID is a registered trademark of Bain & Company (Rogers and Blenko, 2006). RACI (responsible, accountable, consulted, informed) does a similar job for activities rather than decisions.

# Plan in full, or build as you learn?

## Plan in full

- The context is predictable
- The capability to deliver exists
- Mistakes are costly to reverse
- BCG's classical approach

## Build as you learn

- The context is uncertain or contested
- Capability must be built along the way
- Small trials can be reversed cheaply
- BCG's adaptive approach; problem-driven iterative adaptation

**Madhyapur: build as you learn. Pilot in ten wards, review every quarter, scale what works.**

# Risk register: Madhyapur option B (extract)

| Risk | Type | Likelihood | Impact | Owner | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| The contractor resists losing dry waste | Political and commercial | High | Medium | Commissioner | Negotiate now; align with renewal; legal review |
| The cooperative cannot scale | Administrative | Medium | High | Waste department | Pilot first; capacity support |
| Crews divert recyclables | Frontline | Medium | Medium | Ward inspectors | Clear rules; a shared income model |
| Informal settlements left out | Distributional | Medium | High | Ward offices | Include them in the pilot wards |
| Recycling prices fall | Financial | Medium | Medium | The cooperative | A price floor or municipal top-up |

At least five risks, across political, administrative, financial, frontline and distributional types.

# A thinker for your case

## Carol Weiss and Michael Lipsky

*Theory-based evaluation (1995); Street-Level Bureaucracy (1980)*

Weiss argued that programmes rest on implicit theories of how change happens, and that making them explicit lets them be tested. Lipsky reminds us that frontline workers reshape any plan they are asked to deliver.

The question it puts to your case

**Which links in your theory of change are assumptions, and what will frontline workers actually do with the plan?**

Answer it in one sentence in your workbook today.

# Activity: Implementation breakdown simulation

Stress-test an implementation plan against the shocks real programmes face.

### Scenario

Each pod has a sound plan to expand evening bus services for women workers in a stylised city. Every five minutes the facilitator draws a shock card: a budget cut; a transport union objects to new shifts; a data system fails; frontline staff are reassigned to election duty; a safety incident causes public distrust; the state changes the scheme guidelines.

### What to do

1. Read the plan and its theory of change.
2. When a shock card is drawn, decide in three minutes how the plan adapts.
3. Record which link in the theory of change each shock hit.
4. After four shocks, redraw the plan.
5. Compare across pods: which plans bent, and which broke?

**Time** 35 minutes

**Groups** Pods of four

**Output** A revised plan and a list of the links that proved fragile

# Your case: Worksheet 8.1

## Implementation plan

1. Build the theory of change: inputs, activities, outputs, intermediate and final outcomes.
2. Mark every link as evidenced or assumed.
3. Fill the RAPID table for the key decision, with named roles.
4. Choose plan-in-full or build-as-you-learn, with reasons.
5. Write a risk register of at least five risks across five types.

**Hand in**

Worksheet 8.1 by the start of Day 19.

**Quality check**

Every link is marked evidenced or assumed.

Tag every claim in your Analyst's Ledger: fact, inference, assumption or hypothesis.

# What to take away

1. A theory of change makes the assumptions visible: mark each link evidenced or assumed.
2. Name roles and decision rights; leave no activity without an owner.
3. Choose plan-in-full or build-as-you-learn deliberately.
4. Frontline responses and blocking actors belong in the risk register.

**Exit task** Write the assumption in your theory of change that is most likely to fail.

# Before the next session

### Independent work

Draft your full deck (10 to 12 slides) using the capstone structure; Gate 4 reviews it tomorrow. About 60 minutes.

### Read

Rogers and Blenko, "Who Has the D? How Clear Decision Roles Enhance Organizational Performance." Harvard Business Review (2006).

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### Next

## Day 19: Measurement and the pitch

Tomorrow: how you will know it is working, and the pitch. Gate 4.